FINAL PROJECT EVALUATION

Gig Worker Contract Safety Tracker
Nova Collaborative | UN SDG 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth

1. Project Overview

The Gig Worker Contract Safety Tracker was developed to address challenges faced by freelancers and independent contractors in managing contracts, invoices, payment milestones and evidence required to protect themselves against payment disputes and wage theft. The project focused on delivering a practical MVP centred on secure contract management and automated invoicing.

2. Project Objectives

- Provide gig workers with a centralized system for securely managing contract information.
- Improve visibility of invoices and payment status.
- Reduce the risk of payment disputes through better documentation and record keeping.
- Create a practical MVP that demonstrates the core solution within the project timeline.
- Align the solution with UN SDG 8 by supporting fairer and more secure work arrangements for gig workers.

3. Scope and MVP Evaluation

The team appropriately narrowed the original concept to a manageable MVP. The primary focus became:

- Secure contract storage and management.
- Automated invoicing.
- Contract and invoice information tracking.
- A user-facing dashboard and supporting UI/UX designs.
- Security requirements and supporting project documentation.

Additional ideas and integrations were deferred to the backlog so that the team could concentrate on delivering a defendable core product within the available timeframe.

4. Key Deliverables Completed

- Project Charter
- Problem Statement and KPI Framework
- Product Backlog
- Sprint Backlog
- Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)
- Stakeholder Analysis
- Risk Register
- Issues Log

- Team Communication and Meeting Plan
- Project Schedule
- Security Requirements
- Identified Security Issues
- User Acceptance Testing (UAT) Requirements
- UI/UX designs, including user stories, wireframes and user flow
- Meeting Notes
- Published application/MVP
- README and final submission package

5. Product and Technical Evaluation

The team successfully progressed from project definition and design into an implemented MVP. During development, a significant issue was identified in the AI-generated tracker where contract values could be incorrectly extracted. The team traced the issue to limitations in the static design and the interpretation of the PDF upload functionality. The bug was addressed before final submission.

A database gap remained an important technical requirement during final preparation. The team agreed to address this using Google AI Studio with the existing code and security requirements. This highlighted the importance of validating the technical architecture and data layer earlier in the development cycle.

6. Project Performance Evaluation

Evaluation Area	Assessment	Comments
Scope Management	Good	MVP scope was narrowed to achievable core features.
Project Planning	Good	Charter, WBS, backlog, schedule, risks and communication plan were established.
Delivery	Good	Core components and an application were delivered despite technical and infrastructure challenges.
Quality	Needs Improvement	Critical AI extraction issues and technical debt required late-stage troubleshooting.
Communication	Needs Improvement	Siloed work and insufficient feedback on shared documents affected collaboration.
Risk Management	Good	Risks such as power, internet and technical constraints were identified, though mitigation can improve.
Team Collaboration	Good	Strong team spirit and willingness to support one another were demonstrated.
Technical Readiness	Needs Improvement	The database and development

		architecture should have been validated earlier.
Documentation	Strong	A comprehensive set of project and submission documents was produced.

7. What Went Well

- The team maintained strong commitment despite a compressed timeline.
- The MVP scope was successfully refined instead of attempting to build every proposed feature.
- Core project management documentation was produced and maintained.
- The team responded to critical technical issues before submission.
- Team members took ownership of specific deliverables.
- The application was published after resolving a major bug.
- The project remained aligned with its intended SDG 8 impact.

8. Challenges Encountered

- Erratic power supply affected productivity and development continuity.
- Poor or unstable internet connectivity created additional delivery constraints.
- Communication gaps resulted in some siloed work and limited feedback on shared documents.
- Meeting punctuality and coordination could have been stronger.
- The absence of a dedicated developer required the team to learn and adapt to development tools during the project.
- Static Figma designs contributed to difficulties in interpreting certain product functions.
- The database requirement was not fully addressed early enough, creating pressure close to submission.
- Technical debt and AI-generated implementation issues required late-stage troubleshooting.

9. Risk and Issue Management Evaluation

The team demonstrated awareness of operational, technical and infrastructure risks. Power and internet constraints were recurring issues, while technical debt and application behaviour became important delivery risks. The main improvement opportunity is to move from identifying risks to establishing earlier, measurable mitigation actions and contingency plans.

10. Team Collaboration Evaluation

Overall collaboration was positive, with strong team spirit and shared commitment to completing the project. However, the retrospective identified siloed work, limited feedback on shared documents and meeting punctuality as areas requiring improvement. Future projects should establish clearer ownership, regular progress visibility and earlier peer review of deliverables.

11. Lessons Learned

- Define and validate the technical architecture before development begins.
- Prototype important user flows rather than relying only on static designs.
- Break complex deliverables into smaller, testable tasks.
- Communicate blockers early rather than waiting for scheduled meetings.
- Use shared documents as living project artifacts and actively review them as a team.
- Validate AI-generated outputs against known requirements and test data.
- Create contingency plans for infrastructure constraints such as power and internet.
- Reserve time before submission for integration testing, documentation and quality assurance.
- Keep the MVP focused and move non-essential features to the backlog.

12. Final Evaluation

The Gig Worker Contract Safety Tracker project can be assessed as a successful MVP delivery with clear opportunities for technical and process improvement. The team demonstrated effective project planning, adaptability and commitment under time and infrastructure constraints. The project produced substantial supporting documentation and a working application that reflects the identified problem and intended user value.

The most significant areas for future improvement are technical architecture, database readiness, quality assurance, communication discipline and earlier integration testing. Addressing these areas would improve the product's reliability and readiness for a broader pilot or production environment.

13. Recommended Next Steps

- Complete and validate the database and data model.
- Conduct structured end-to-end testing using realistic contract and invoice data.
- Complete UAT with representative gig workers.
- Strengthen authentication, authorization and data protection controls.
- Improve error handling and validation for contract data extraction.
- Document the technical architecture and deployment process.
- Prioritize backlog items based on user feedback and MVP performance.
- Collect post-MVP feedback and define measurable product success metrics.
- Conduct a final security review before any wider public release.

14. Final Assessment Summary

Project Outcome	Successful MVP delivery
Overall Assessment	Good — with identified technical and process improvements
Primary Strength	Strong project ownership, documentation and adaptability
Primary Improvement Area	Technical readiness, QA and team communication
Recommended Status	Proceed to validation, testing and iterative improvement

15. Conclusion

The project achieved its core objective of developing a practical solution concept and MVP for improving contract and payment management for gig workers. Although the team encountered significant technical, communication and infrastructure challenges, it adapted and delivered the principal project outputs. The experience provides a strong foundation for further product validation and demonstrates the team's ability to apply project management, product development and collaborative problem-solving practices in a real-world project environment.